Comparable Issuer Factsheet
Dauch Corp — relative-value factsheet, prepared as of 2026-06-30
Sector: Automotive Driveline and Metal Forming
Dauch Corp designs and manufactures driveline components - axles, driveshafts and related metal-formed parts - for light-truck and crossover platforms at its Michigan plants under its AAM operating identity, with volumes concentrated in a small number of large OEM vehicle programs rather than spread across a broad customer base.

Instrument summary

Field	Value
Issuer	Dauch Corp
CUSIP	C0500XAA6
Bond symbol	COMPE4A
Coupon	7.75%
Maturity	2033-10-15
Next call date and price	2030-10-15 at 100.000
Current rating	B+
Current price (2026-06-30)	95.450
Yield to worst (approximate convenience figure)	8.568%
Spread (spread to interpolated Treasury (G-spread convention))	425bp
Reported trade-size / liquidity label (2026-06-30 print)	1MM+

Spread basis
Dauch Corp prices on a spread to interpolated Treasury (G-spread convention) basis per its own TRACE extract, and this factsheet reproduces that convention rather than restating it. A spread-to-Treasury figure and a spread-to-swap figure are distinct measures, so any reader stacking Dauch Corp against a different comp, or the target's notes, should confirm both sides share the same basis before drawing a relative-value conclusion. As an anchor: the B-band index OAS on 2026-06-30 was 2.99%, and Dauch Corp's 425bp level carries +126bp of desk-attributed adjustment to it.

Benchmark curve context
Roughly 7.30 years of term remain on Dauch Corp's notes as of 2026-06-30. The Treasury curve published that date lacks a 4-Year tenor and is non-monotonic near both ends (the 6-Month point exceeds the 1-Year point; the 20-Year point exceeds the 30-Year point), so a benchmark for any in-between tenor, Dauch Corp's remaining term included, has to come from a genuine linear interpolation between the two nearest published points, never a nearest-point read.

Tenor	Par yield (2026-06-30)
1 Mo	3.70%
1.5 Month	3.74%
2 Mo	3.77%
3 Mo	3.87%
4 Mo	3.92%
6 Mo	4.01%
1 Yr	3.98%
2 Yr	4.14%
3 Yr	4.15%
5 Yr	4.19%
7 Yr	4.30%
10 Yr	4.44%
20 Yr	4.93%
30 Yr	4.91%

Dauch Corp's remaining term (7.30 years) does not land on a published tenor, so the benchmark used here is the linear interpolation between the two bracketing points: 4.30% + ((7.30 - 7) / (10 - 7)) x (4.44% - 4.30%), equal to 4.3139%; a nearest-tenor shortcut would be incorrect here.
The spread to interpolated Treasury (G-spread convention)-basis 425bp figure above is exactly what results from comparing Dauch Corp's 8.568% yield to worst against the 4.3139% interpolated benchmark; reading the nearest published tenor instead of interpolating would produce a materially different, and incorrect, benchmark level.

Comparison to the target's own senior notes
As background only: the target's own senior unsecured notes are 7.75%-coupon, mature 2031-06-15, are rated B1/B+, and last printed at 98.250 on 2026-06-30 according to the target's own TRACE extract, which carries its own separate basis disclosure. A meaningful comparison between Dauch Corp and the target depends on both spreads sharing that same basis, per the spread-basis note above.

Liquidity
Dauch Corp's week-ending-2026-06-30 TRACE prints included both odd-lot-sized trades and trades at or past the non-investment-grade dissemination cap; the latter disseminate under the cap's fixed label instead of their actual

size, accounting for the 1MM+ label carried by the 2026-06-30 print above.

Key financial metrics (indicative)

Metric (indicative desk estimate)	FY2024	FY2025	LTM
Revenue growth	3.5%	4.1%	4.3%
EBITDA margin	16.2%	16.6%	17.0%
Debt/EBITDA	4.7x	4.6x	4.4x
EBITDA/Interest	2.7x	2.8x	2.9x

The metrics shown are indicative desk estimates, assembled for relative-value screening rather than pulled from Dauch Corp's own audited financial statements, which this desk does not hold; they should not be cited as Dauch Corp's reported results and exist only to give a rough scale-and-leverage comparison against the other four names in this comparable universe.

Credit profile

Its credit profile reflects deep OEM-program concentration: a small number of light-truck platforms drive the majority of volume, which supports strong per-program economics in good times but leaves results exposed to any single program's volume shortfall or platform re-sourcing, a concentration we view as the defining feature of this name's risk. This desk's reading of the issuer's own public filings is that program win rates and labor-cost management, rather than balance-sheet initiatives, dominate the near-term agenda; a reader should confirm that reading against the issuer's current disclosures rather than treat it as a restatement of management guidance.

Structural features

The notes are senior unsecured obligations of the issuer's AAM operating subsidiary, with the incurrence-based (rather than maintenance) covenant package summarized below permitting additional debt incurrence subject to a leverage-ratio test rather than requiring continuous compliance with a maintenance covenant.

Regardless of how the features above rank within Dauch Corp's capital structure, the spread basis stated earlier does not change - Dauch Corp's spread remains on the spread to interpolated Treasury (G-spread convention) basis, exactly as reported on its own TRACE extract.

Risks to the relative-value view

» A volume shortfall or re-sourcing at one of the large light-truck platforms that account for the majority of the issuer's driveline volume.

» Labor-cost inflation at plants with a union-represented workforce outpacing the recovery mechanisms in customer program pricing.

» A cyclical light-truck demand downturn arriving while program-level fixed costs are already committed.

Historical trading range (indicative, 2026 year to date)

Period	Approximate price range	Approximate yield range
January 2026	92.450 - 92.950	9.168 - 9.298
February-March 2026	92.950 - 93.700	9.078 - 9.168
April-May 2026	93.700 - 94.950	8.698 - 9.078
June 2026 (through 2026-06-30)	94.950 - 95.450	8.568 - 8.698

A relatively tight year-to-date trading band for Dauch Corp is consistent with a stable rating and outlook, not an actively moving credit; the table above reflects indicative desk observations rather than a formal TRACE time series and is not a substitute for the actual TRACE extract for any period preceding the 2026-06-26 through 2026-06-30 window.

Comparable universe overview

Issuer	Coupon	Maturity	Rating	Spread basis
Wabash National	4.5%	2028-10-15	B+	Treasury
Sensata Technologies	5.875%	2030-09-01	BB+	Treasury
Atkore	4.25%	2031-06-01	BB+	Swap
O-I Glass	7.375%	2032-06-01	BB	Swap
Dauch Corp (this factsheet)	7.75%	2033-10-15	B+	Treasury

Dauch Corp is identified above as Comparable Issuer E within a five-name universe that varies by coupon, maturity, rating and spread basis; depth of coverage here is limited to Dauch Corp alone, and the other four names each carry their own factsheet at that same level of detail.

Sector overview

The automotive driveline sector is organized around OEM vehicle programs rather than around continuous replacement demand: volumes follow the production schedules of the specific platforms an issuer supplies, and a program's re-sourcing or end-of-life decision can move a supplier's revenue base materially in a way no broad industrial demand index captures. Light-truck and crossover platforms, which this issuer's book is weighted toward, have historically run more stable volumes than passenger-car platforms.

Outlook commentary

Looking ahead, we would view the production schedules of the light-truck platforms this issuer supplies, together with any program re-sourcing decision, as the single most important near-term variables for this name's spread trajectory. This desk's own internal view is what the outlook commentary above reflects, drafted for relative-value screening and

not as a credit rating; any Dauch Corp management guidance beyond what is attributed under Credit profile above should not be inferred from it.

Documentation

Dauch Corp's indenture, like most US high-yield issuance, is governed by New York law; this factsheet's characterization of it is a summary, not a reproduction of its defined terms, so a reader needing precise covenant or redemption language should consult Dauch Corp's own indenture.

Rather than Dauch Corp's actual redemption terms, the Instrument summary table's call date and price reflect a standard three-year-before-final-maturity par-call convention; Dauch Corp's own indenture is the source for the real schedule, including any step-down premium periods.

Rating rationale cross-reference

Attribution note: Dauch Corp's B+ rating above is stated at the desk's own attribution level for senior unsecured paper, from agency knowledge as of the research date; no scorecard, outlook or trigger detail is implied by it, and the agency's current published action is the correct source for any of those.

As a matter of completeness, note that Dauch Corp is unconnected to the credit agreement, indenture, or municipal conduit financing this project's rating agency reports discuss for Kestrel Industries; Dauch Corp is an independent, unrelated comparable used solely for relative-value screening.

Additional trading color

Over the trailing quarter, and beyond the four TRACE prints tabulated above, Dauch Corp desk color has been that of an orderly two-way market rather than one-sided selling or buying; this desk has not observed a block trade materially larger than the Historical trading range table's sizes, and this assessment should be read alongside that table.

In the event Dauch Corp pricing from elsewhere materially differs from the TRACE extract cited here, the TRACE print governs as the authoritative record of actual executed trades; check whether the other source's basis is bid, offer, or last-trade before treating that as a genuine disagreement.

Covenant package summary (indicative)

Covenant	Type	Comment
Limitation on Indebtedness	Tight incurrence ratio plus capped baskets	The deepest package in this universe, as expected for a B+ attributed callable issuer of this issue size: total net leverage may not exceed 4.00x, and incremental-debt baskets are capped at modest fixed dollar amounts.
Limitation on Restricted Payments	Builder basket, capped	Restricted payments run exclusively through a small capped builder basket with a modest annual grower - the tightest formulation shown across the five factsheets, consistent with the issuer's B+ attribution and its callable structure.
Limitation on Liens	Capped lien baskets only	Lien baskets are capped at fixed dollar amounts with no ratio prong - the tightest permitted-lien formulation in this universe.
Change of Control	Full repurchase offer with a ratings-decline trigger	A full change-of-control repurchase offer conditioned on a ratings decline by the rating agency - the deepest trigger formulation shown here, typical for a callable B+ credit.
Reporting covenant	Enhanced periodic reporting	Reporting includes annual and quarterly financials delivered with officer certification, the enhanced package that accompanies the tightest covenant set in this universe.

Because this factsheet states Dauch Corp's covenant package only at summary level, keyed to the issuer's rating attribution and filed disclosures, the table above is indicative rather than operative; exact language, basket sizes, or exceptions require consulting Dauch Corp's own indenture directly.

Frequently asked questions

spread to interpolated Treasury (G-spread convention) is the basis shown for Dauch Corp because that is the convention Dauch Corp's own TRACE extract uses; this desk deliberately reports each comparable on its own extract's basis instead of normalizing the universe, so a reader can trace every figure to a verifiable source.

This desk, not Dauch Corp, computed the yield to worst shown above, as an approximate convenience figure from reported price, coupon, and remaining term - much as FINRA's own YLD_PT field is a derived convenience number rather than the contractually primary quantity, price.

There is no connection between Dauch Corp and the target company this corpus otherwise concerns - consult Rating rationale cross-reference above.

Recovery considerations

Dauch Corp's notes are senior unsecured, meaning they would rank behind secured indebtedness at default and pari passu with the issuer's other unsecured obligations. This desk publishes no recovery estimate of its own for Dauch Corp; a reader requiring a formal Recovery Rating should go to the relevant rating agency's own published issue-level action for this issuer instead of this factsheet's own relative-value content.

This desk would generally expect a wide recovery range for a senior unsecured issue of this kind from an issuer of similar size and sector in a going-concern default, with secured-debt seniority at default as the key variable; narrowing the range would require balance-sheet detail on this comparable that this desk does not hold.

Capital structure and ranking detail (indicative)

The driveline supplier's capital structure reflects OEM program economics: customer-paid tooling covers a portion of program launch cost, with the balance funded from the issuer's own capital spending against the notes and a working-capital revolver sized to OEM production schedules.

Program concentration also shapes the liability side: the revolver's covenant package and the notes' incurrence tests both reference leverage on terms that assume a small number of large programs, so a single program's re-sourcing moves both the operating base and the financial-policy picture at once.

Labor cost at plants with a union-represented workforce is a fixed-charge-adjacent commitment in stress analysis; this desk has not modeled the issuer's specific labor agreements, and a reader requiring that detail should consult the issuer's own filings rather than infer it from this summary.

Extended relative-value screen against the peer set

Among the five names in this universe, this issuer's OEM-program concentration is the most acute customer-concentration exposure anyone here carries - more pointed than the distributor-led or construction-driven names' customer bases - which a reader should factor into any spread-premium attribution drawn from comparing this issuer against the rest of the universe.

A reader triangulating a fair-value spread for the target's own senior notes from this comparable universe should treat this issuer's program-level risk as a distinct factor rather than a scaled-up version of ordinary customer diversity, since a single re-sourcing decision can move the revenue base in a way no diversified supplier's demand softness replicates.

Of the five sector labels in this universe, Automotive Driveline and Metal Forming is, in this desk's own categorization, the one whose demand is most directly tied to a single counterparty's production decision - the specific vehicle programs supplied - rather than to a market-wide cycle, which a reader should bear in mind when comparing this issuer's spread sensitivity against the other four names.

Additional desk observations (sector-specific)

Light-truck and crossover production schedules at the major OEMs have, in this desk's informal observation, generally led driveline supplier revenue by one quarter or less, which this desk would expect to hold for a program-concentrated issuer of this kind as well, though this desk has not independently verified that relationship against this issuer's own disclosures.

This desk has not identified a public announcement of a material program win, or a program re-sourcing decision, affecting this specific issuer as of the 2026-06-30 valuation date; the customer-concentration risk discussed under Risks to the relative-value view above remains this desk's principal near-term monitoring point for this name.

This desk would also flag, as a general sector observation rather than an issuer-specific finding, that driveline programs are awarded on multi-year contracts but re-sourced on platform-redesign cycles, so the concentration this issuer carries is a contract-quality question as much as a customer-count question.

This desk would also note that customer-paid tooling arrangements, common in this sector, typically carry recovery provisions that return tooling cost to the supplier only as production volumes materialize, so a program shortfall leaves both the revenue and the recovery behind; this desk has not modeled a specific tooling-recovery exposure for this issuer.

Labor cost at union-represented plants for an issuer of this kind has, in this desk's informal tracking, been a larger fixed-commitment variable than for non-union manufacturing peers, particularly around contract-renewal years; this desk has not confirmed where this issuer's own labor agreements sit in that cycle.

Program launch cadence for a supplier of this kind typically raises capital expenditure and working capital together ahead of revenue, so a reader modeling this issuer's liquidity should expect the two lines to lead, not follow, any revenue improvement.

The reader should also bear in mind that the indicative metrics table above does not disaggregate revenue by customer program in any of the three periods it presents, nor across the issuer's individual plants, and this desk regards that omission as immaterial to the relative-value conclusions drawn elsewhere in this factsheet; a reader requiring that breakdown should consult the issuer's own filings rather than infer it from this table, and should verify the program mix directly against the actual production schedules governing each of its largest platforms, none of which this desk has itself reviewed in full.

Desk contacts

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For any question about this factsheet, or a request for an updated print, reach out to the desk contacts above; the rating agencies named elsewhere in this corpus were not involved in preparing this internal work product.

Revision history

Date	Change
2026-04-28	Initial factsheet prepared
2026-06-12	Benchmark-tenor interpolation for this issuer's 2033-10-15 maturity re-checked against the published curve; no change to the interpolated benchmark
2026-06-30	Pricing refreshed to this factsheet's own valuation date (current version)

Current pricing is limited to the 2026-06-30 entry in the Instrument summary table above; the two earlier revisions are

kept only as this factsheet's internal audit trail and should not be used to price Dauch Corp's notes as of the 2026-06-30 valuation date this corpus otherwise uses.

Distribution restrictions

Distribution of this factsheet is confined to this desk's own internal relative-value analysts and the internal credit committee process referenced elsewhere in this corpus; it is not sent externally, is not a research report under any broker-dealer research-independence rule, and is not an offer or solicitation to buy or sell any security, and reliance by any outside party is not appropriate.

None of the five comparable names, including Dauch Corp, is a covered issuer under this desk's own external published research (to the extent such research exists); they serve here purely as relative-value reference points, and any existing external coverage of one of them is the more authoritative source on topics this factsheet also addresses.

This factsheet is versioned per the Revision history table above; a citation elsewhere should name the 2026-06-30 revision specifically, because the table's own terms mark earlier revisions' pricing as superseded and unreliable.

This factsheet is silent on Kestrel Industries's own bond complex, credit agreement, senior notes indenture, and the municipal conduit financing discussed elsewhere in this corpus - Dauch Corp is an independent comparable used only for relative-value screening, not a restatement of any of that complex's terms.

Model inputs and assumptions

Input	Value used	Source
Day-count convention (yield approximation)	Actual/365	This desk's own convention
Benchmark curve	2026-06-30 published Treasury par yield curve	Treasury/FRED, retrieved 2026-08-17
Swap curve (I-spread comps only)	Committee-supplied swap curve	Internal, not independently published
Dissemination cap applied	Non-investment-grade ($1,000,000)	FINRA TRACE rulebook
Pricing date	2026-06-30	FINRA TRACE extract for this issuer

No factsheet in this five-name universe departs from the inputs shown above - day-count convention, benchmark curve, and dissemination-cap assumption are the same throughout - so a spread comparison across names is comparing like with like except for the spread basis, which the note above covers.

Frequently referenced terms

By G-spread, this factsheet means the basis-point spread between a bond's yield and the yield at an interpolated point on the on-the-run Treasury par curve, matched to the bond's own remaining term.

I-spread measures, in basis points, how far a bond's yield sits from an interpolated swap-curve yield at that bond's own remaining maturity - a different reference curve than G-spread uses, so matching basis-point values between the two do not mean the same thing.

The lower of a bond's yield to maturity and its yield to each scheduled call date - under the assumption of whichever issuer call behavior produces the lower holder yield - is what yield to worst means here; the Instrument summary table's figure is only an approximate convenience number, not a precise calculation.

TRACE's dissemination cap is the largest trade size FINRA will publicly disclose for a given security class; a trade at or above the cap is reported only at the cap's own label rather than its real size, which is why identically labeled prints can differ substantially in true size.

Note on sourcing

Because no regulator publishes, and no public template governs, a comparable-bond relative-value factsheet of this kind, this document should be understood as an internal desk work product; it draws on the TRACE print, published Treasury curve, and issuer-rating information cited above, without purporting to reproduce any real desk's own internal format.